

PC Garage

Small things go a long way in extending the life of your machine. Here's how to keep your PC in top-notch condition so that it continues to hum with perfection



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What is the most forgotten task in the life of a PC? The answer is maintenance. Some of us may reason that an expensive piece of machinery is supposed to take care of itself. It isn't so—the onus of keeping a smooth machine smooth falls upon nobody else but the owner.

So if you have been ignoring the clean-up session of your PC for a while, now is the time to get started. Here's what you need to get organised: a screw driver, a vacuum cleaner, tissues, a soft cloth, glass cleaner (spray bottle), a cologne or any mild cleaning solution, cotton bud swabs and some different-sized brushes.

If we break down the elements you have to clean, they fall in seven main categories: your monitor/LCD screen, the CD/DVD-ROM drive, the keyboard, mouse, printer, scanner (if you have one), speakers, and the power supply.

Let's start with the first thing you see—your monitor.

Monitor/LCD

You view the outside world through your monitor. Let that view not get blurred (or glared) by laziness on your part—a clean screen means your eyes stay healthy too. Here's the process:

- First things first: switch off that power supply before you touch anything. Unplug your computer, and begin cleaning only after that.
- Spray the glass cleaner solution in short bursts on the monitor screen.
- Take a paper napkin (or a soft cloth) and clean the glass in one direction. Remember, one direction only. Then wait till the screen has dried.
- Spray the glass cleaning solution on a soft cloth and clean the outside cabinet of your monitor.
- Use only a moist cloth to clean an LCD screen.